



IS AI SUSTAINABLE?

(From left) **Jui Joshi**, Partner, Climate Collective

Namrata Rana, National Head—ESG, KPMG in India

Rajesh Kumar Jha, Country Sustainability Manager, ABB India
Suruchi Bhadwal, Director, Earth Science & Climate Change, TERI

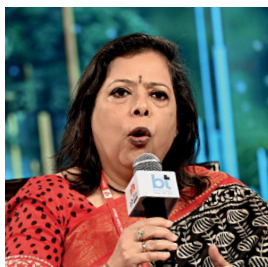
» “It is not AI versus sustainability. We need to view them together,” Jui said, adding that technology doesn’t mean an adverse thing. It all depends on the usage

» “Data centres don’t necessarily need water. There are many other cooling technologies that can be used; there are many sources of clean power. We now need to design how to use it best,” said Rana

» “We have to break down individual sectors and then see the work done in them... and work is being done to make the system more sustainable. However, a lot more needs to be done,” said Jha

» “There is a big environmental footprint of digitisation... We need to put our heads together and see how to move towards tech that can help us,” Bhadwal said

CLIMATE FINANCE: THE MISSING MONEY



Leena Nandan, Former Secretary, MoEFCC

» Sustainable development is the larger goal that India needs to accomplish: This is the thought that Nandan began the discussion with, adding that global financing has been too little, too late



Samir Sharma, Head—CSR & Sustainability, L&T Finance

» “If there is a slight nudge to rules, and through proper guidelines, a lot of money can be mobilised,” Sharma said, adding that the risks in climate financing are front ended



Shriram Subramanian, MD, InGovern

» “India has capital but we don’t use it productively. We don’t have accountability for the 80% of capital that we spend, we don’t have disclosures,” Subramanian opined



Nikunj Dube, Chief Ratings Officer, CareEdge—ESG Ratings

» India lacks taxonomy for green financing. Also, the lender needs to understand to not put money in greenwashing, which is why the taxonomy becomes more important, Dube said